

Community waiting list within 18 weeks

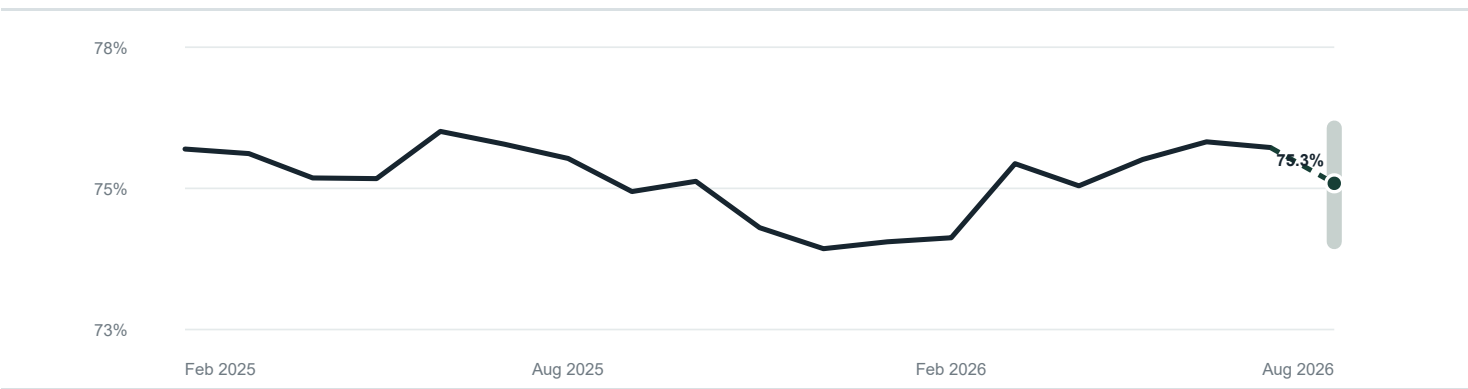
Forecast for August 2026 · data through July 2026

Community waiting list within 18 weeks is forecast to deteriorate at the next release, from 75.9% to 75.3%. The model's expected deterioration is mainly driven by the underlying trend; the seasonal effect is small. The current projection is off course for 78% by March 2027.

LATEST · JULY 2026	OUTLOOK · AUGUST 2026	ACTUAL
75.9%	75.3%	
No archived pre-release forecast	80% range 74.2%–76.3%	Not yet released
		Off course · 78% by March 2027

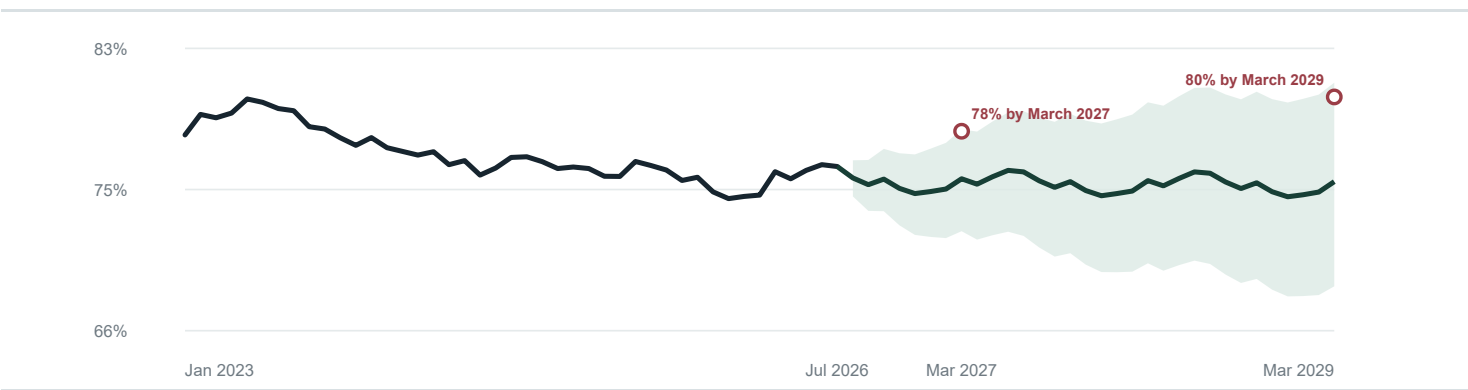
Recent performance and next release

The vertical band is the 80% expected range.



Longer-term outlook and milestones

Descriptive projection; not forced to meet targets.



Benchmark: 80% by March 2029. 2.8pp below milestone
Data: NHS England community health services waiting lists. Targets: Medium Term Planning Framework interim target - Medium Term Planning Framework final target
Method: Backtest-weighted ensemble of current-level seasonal movement, damped annual drift and a damped recent seasonal trend; at least 2 components are required. The final fit uses 43 consecutive months. Accuracy is tested on 12 rolling one-month-ahead forecasts. The 80% range uses empirical historical error quantiles from 12 forecast errors. Weights use inverse rolling RMSE and are shrunk toward equal weights. The pre-release commentary compares the current-level seasonal component with the combined forecast. Provider page withheld. Provider trajectory watch is disabled for this measure.

Community waits by service

England · July 2026

SERVICE MIX

Where waits over 18 weeks are concentrated

Services differ greatly in size. This ranks the published service categories by the number waiting over 18 weeks; it is a descriptive breakdown, not a forecast or provider comparison.

47

services with a reported total waiting list

43

services with complete published over-18-week bands

SERVICE	TOTAL WAITING	OVER 18 WEEKS	WITHIN 18 WEEKS
Community paediatric service	177,962	129,584	27.2%
Musculoskeletal service	442,807	71,863	83.8%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language	64,579	21,843	66.2%
Podiatry and podiatric surgery	109,759	15,046	86.3%
Nursing and Therapy support for LTCs: Continence/ colostomy	43,850	6,458	85.3%
Therapy interventions: Occupational therapy	21,156	6,186	70.8%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics	34,143	5,193	84.8%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy	42,449	4,932	88.4%
Audiology	19,133	4,859	74.6%
Therapy interventions: Speech and language	27,117	4,849	82.1%
Audiology	17,032	3,269	80.8%
Rehabilitation services (integrated)	44,016	3,191	92.8%
Therapy interventions: Physiotherapy	20,732	2,674	87.1%
Neurorehabilitation (multi-disciplinary)	13,597	2,482	81.7%
Therapy interventions: Dietetics	8,083	2,144	73.5%

Coverage and interpretation. Ranked by the published number waiting over 18 weeks. Complete over-18 bands were available for 43 of 47 services with a reported total. Rows with suppressed or incomplete bands are excluded from the ranking. The national headline on page 1 remains the authoritative aggregate. The within-18-week percentage is total waiting less all published over-18-week bands, divided by total. NHS England notes that the sum of weekly bands may not match the total where some providers were still collecting waits by weeks; reconciliation differences are retained in the QA outputs.